

on social media platform Instagram, the hashtag has 376,000 followers.

Celebs from Meghan Markle to Gwyneth Paltrow swear by it, and the Kardashians have their own celebrity trainer. Closer home, Malaika Arora also touts the powers of facial fitness.

So, what exactly is face yoga? "It is a set of exercises performed to tone and stretch facial muscles. We have over 57 muscles on our face and neck. Face yoga involves massages and ex-

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ercises that stimulate the muscles, skin, and lymphatic system," says Delhi-based certified face yoga coach Mamta Sansanwal, who has been teaching face yoga for the past three years and has shared her knowledge with more than 4,000 people.

New York-based author Annelise Hagen is a certified yoga thera-

pist who has been teaching and practicing face yoga since 2005. In her book *The Yoga Face*, she says that the muscles of the face are no different from the muscles of the rest of the body. If you don't exercise the muscles below the neck, they become weak and flabby, and the same thing will happen to your face with age. Just as yoga routines work the muscles in the body, the stretches and movements of face yoga tighten and tone the facial muscles.

And just like yoga, face yoga has no age restriction. "An older person can derive benefits from practising yoga techniques that promote facial rejuvenation, and a younger person can cultivate habits that will last a lifetime. You can start as young as 14, but of course it needs to be done under supervision; the focus is more on preventive and maintenance routines at that age," says Sansanwal, who herself started practicing face yoga a few years ago to get rid of pigmentation and dull skin.

Hagen says there are three different ways in which face yoga may work for you. First, it stimulates the muscles and improves their tone and tightness. Second, it increases blood flow and circulation on the face, making it appear healthier. And finally, it helps reduce stress and anxiety; other benefits include glowing skin,

